



The Morning Brief

MAY 24, 2026

Hormuz Pivot

Trump's weekend announcement that an Iran deal is largely negotiated reframes the energy setup as the holiday-shortened week loads PCE and Dell into Thursday.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI) \$745.64 · ↑0.39%	BRENT (BNO, FRI) \$55.00 · ↓1.01%	BITCOIN (SPOT, LIVE) ~\$76,600 · range-bound	HORMUZ FRAMEWORK Trump: largely negotiated	FEAR & GREED 25 · Extreme Fear
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SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review

AN EIGHTH CONSECUTIVE WEEKLY GAIN INTO MEMORIAL DAY CLOSED WITH THE S&P AT \$745.64 (↑0.39% FRIDAY) AND THE DOW ON FRESH RECORD TERRITORY — THE DOMINANT WEEKEND DEVELOPMENT THEN ARRIVED SATURDAY WHEN PRESIDENT TRUMP DESCRIBED AN IRAN FRAMEWORK INCLUDING A REOPENED STRAIT OF HORMUZ AS LARGELY NEGOTIATED, AN ANNOUNCEMENT THAT COULD MATERIALLY SHIFT THE ENERGY BACKDROP CARRYING CRUDE

The week into the holiday closed quietly constructive: the S&P 500 ETF finished Friday at \$745.64 (↑0.39%), the Dow proxy at \$506.12 (↑0.60%) on fresh record territory, the Nasdaq proxy at \$717.54 (↑0.42%), and the Russell 2000 led the majors at \$285.12 (↑0.93%). Per multiple outlets, the S&P logged its eighth consecutive weekly gain, with single-stock catalysts inside the IOWN sleeve providing Friday's leadership rather than index components — QCOM (↑11.60%) on the expanded Stellantis Snapdragon partnership, CRDO (↑12.94%), and NXPI (↑5.71%). The dominant weekend development arrived after Friday's close: per CNBC, NPR, and PBS coverage, President Trump stated Saturday that a deal with Iran — including reopening the Strait of Hormuz — had been largely negotiated following calls with regional partners, with the final terms expected to be announced shortly. Per Axios reporting Sunday, the framework under discussion contemplates a sixty-day ceasefire window during which Hormuz would be reopened without tolls, Iran would clear its mine deployments, the US would lift the port blockade, and parallel two-month negotiations on the nuclear file would proceed. Discussed in Section 02.

S&P 500 · DOW · NASDAQ (FRI)	\$745.64 ↑0.39% · \$506.12 ↑0.60% · \$717.54 ↑0.42%
WEEKLY MOVE (PER YAHOO)	Eighth straight weekly gain for S&P · Dow at fresh records
FRIDAY SECTOR BREADTH	XLV ↑1.17% · XLK ↑1.00% · XLC ↓0.55% (only laggard)
BITCOIN (SPOT, LIVE)	Range-bound near \$76,600 per weekend tape · flat to Fri close
FEAR & GREED	25 · Extreme Fear
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY \$645.80 support · Untested (Fri low \$744.48 — roughly 15% above)

THE HOLIDAY-SHORTENED WEEK LOADS THURSDAY WITH THE APRIL PCE PRINT AND DELL'S Q1 REPORT INTO A CALENDAR ALREADY WEIGHING THE IMPLICATIONS OF A POTENTIAL HORMUZ REOPENING — THE MACRO READ ON INFLATION AND THE SINGLE-STOCK READ ON AI-SERVER DEMAND WILL LAND INSIDE THE SAME SESSION

The compressed calendar concentrates the week's catalysts into Thursday morning. Per the BEA release schedule, the

April Personal Income and Outlays report — carrying the PCE Deflator the Fed cites as its preferred inflation measure — releases at 8:30 AM ET on May 28, alongside the second GDP estimate. Per analyst commentary referenced in our coverage, Bank of America has pushed its next-cut call into July 2027 from a prior September 2026 view, with market-implied odds of no cuts in 2026 sitting near seventy percent. The same Thursday morning brings Dell Technologies' fiscal Q1 print before the open — an AI-server read for the IOWN semiconductor and power sleeves even though Dell is not a holding. Per multiple outlets, Bank of America expects Dell to beat both revenue and EPS estimates and raise full-year guidance following the company's product blitz at Dell Technologies World earlier this month, which featured eighteenth-generation PowerEdge servers and an expanded NVIDIA-collaboration agentic AI deskside system. A constructive Dell read would extend the data-center capital cycle thesis that VST, NEE, LRCX, TSM, and CRDO depend on.

An eighth straight weekly gain, a potential Hormuz framework that arrived after Friday's close, and a Thursday morning loaded with the Fed's preferred inflation gauge alongside an AI-server bellwether — the macro and the micro now converge inside the same session. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics

PRESIDENT TRUMP STATED SATURDAY THAT A FRAMEWORK WITH IRAN — INCLUDING A REOPENED STRAIT OF HORMUZ — HAD BEEN LARGELY NEGOTIATED AND WOULD BE ANNOUNCED SHORTLY — PER REPORTING, THE CONTEMPLATED TERMS INCLUDE A SIXTY-DAY CEASEFIRE WINDOW, MINE-CLEARING IN THE STRAIT, A LIFTED US PORT BLOCKADE, AND PARALLEL TWO-MONTH NEGOTIATIONS ON THE NUCLEAR FILE, THOUGH IRAN'S FOREIGN MINISTRY HAS DISPUTED THAT THE NUCLEAR TRACK IS INSIDE THE CURRENT DISCUSSION

The dominant weekend development materially shifts the negotiating posture the prior brief described. Per CNBC, NPR, PBS, and CBS coverage, President Trump posted Saturday that a deal with Iran had been largely negotiated following calls with leaders from Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, Jordan, Bahrain, and separately with Israel, with final terms expected to be announced shortly. Per Axios reporting Sunday, the framework under discussion contemplates a sixty-day ceasefire window during which the Strait of Hormuz would be reopened with no tolls, Iran would clear the mines it deployed in the waterway, the US would lift its port blockade, and sanctions waivers would allow Iran to sell oil; parallel two-month negotiations on the nuclear file would proceed alongside. Per the same coverage, the deal has not been finalized and could still fall apart. The two structural gaps the prior brief flagged remain at least partially open. First, per Times of Israel reporting Saturday, Iranian state media contradicted the Hormuz reopening framing, saying the strait would remain under Iran's management. Second, per Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesperson cited in CBS coverage, nuclear issues are not part of current negotiations from Tehran's perspective — with the focus instead on ending the war and lifting sanctions. The market read on Sunday evening would depend on whether a formal announcement materializes.

THE IMPLICATIONS FOR THE IOWN ENERGY SLEEVE ARE MATERIAL AND TWO-SIDED — A CONFIRMED HORMUZ REOPENING WOULD PRESSURE NEAR-TERM CRUDE AND THE SLEEVE'S PHYSICAL-SUPPLY PREMIUM, WHILE THE STRUCTURAL CAPACITY THESIS THE SLEEVE WAS BUILT AROUND DOES NOT RESET ON A SINGLE HEADLINE; DEFENSE NAMES RETAIN THEIR ORTHOGONAL-HEDGE ROLE THROUGH THE TRANSITION

The IOWN energy positioning was constructed around the physical-supply thesis — constrained capacity, supply discipline, and the “physical world matters” framework — rather than around an escalation path. A formal Hormuz reopening within sixty days would, per Wood Mackenzie commentary referenced in prior briefs, point spot Brent toward \$80 by year-end as the war-risk premium unwinds. The sleeve's laggards from Friday illustrate the sensitivity: CTRA closed at \$32.56 (↓8.62%) and CNX at \$35.31 (↓0.68%), with USO and BNO both posting weekly losses on progress signals before the Saturday announcement landed. Counterweight: per Goldman Sachs commentary referenced previously, the late-2026 Brent view sits closer to \$90 on more persistent disruption, and the structural call on capacity and demand does not reset on a procedural framework alone. For VLO (Fri ↑2.43% to \$246.96) and CVX (Fri ↑0.22% to \$191.43), the downstream and integrated profiles diversify the

exposure relative to the upstream-and-gas concentration. Defense exposure (LMT Fri ↑2.00% to \$533.24, GD ↑1.23% to \$342.89) retains its orthogonal-hedge role through the transition window — a sixty-day ceasefire is not a permanent retirement of the underlying risk. The committee's discipline tends to weigh both sides rather than reposition on a single weekend headline before the formal terms are confirmed.

TRUMP STATEMENT (SAT, MAY 23)	Deal described as largely negotiated per CNBC/NPR/PBS · final terms to be announced shortly
FRAMEWORK TERMS (PER AXIOS)	60-day ceasefire · Hormuz reopened, no tolls · Iran clears mines · US lifts blockade
IRANIAN PUSHBACK	State media: strait stays under Iran's management per Times of Israel
IRAN FOREIGN MINISTRY	Nuclear file not part of current discussion per CBS coverage
BRENT OUTLOOK (PRIOR BRIEF)	~\$80 year-end if Hormuz opens by June per Wood Mackenzie · ~\$90 late-2026 per Goldman
IOWN DEFENSE (FRI)	LMT ↑2.00% · GD ↑1.23% · orthogonal hedge intact through transition

On Our Radar

1. The Saturday Trump statement is the variable that defines Tuesday's open — if a formal Iran framework is announced before Asia trades, crude could open notably lower and the IOWN energy sleeve would carry the directional risk; if the framework slips or is contested by Tehran, the war-risk premium tends to re-enter the tape against a Fear & Greed reading already at 25. Per CNBC, NPR, and Axios coverage, the contemplated framework includes a sixty-day ceasefire window, a reopened Strait of Hormuz with no tolls, mine-clearing by Iran, and a lifted US blockade in exchange for parallel two-month nuclear negotiations. Per Times of Israel and CBS coverage, Iranian state media and the Foreign Ministry have separately contested elements of the framing — suggesting the announcement is not a closed file. The committee's discipline through the transition window tends to favor weighing both sides rather than repositioning on a single weekend headline before formal terms confirm. *Avoid Erosion.*

2. Thursday morning stacks the April PCE print and Dell's fiscal Q1 report into the same session — the gating macro read on Fed expectations and the bellwether single-stock read on AI-server demand land before the open inside a holiday-shortened week. Per the BEA release schedule, the April Personal Income and Outlays report releases at 8:30 AM ET on May 28 alongside the second GDP estimate; Dell reports the same morning per its investor calendar. Per analyst commentary referenced in our coverage, Bank of America expects Dell to beat both revenue and EPS estimates and raise full-year guidance following the company's product blitz at Dell Technologies World, which featured eighteenth-generation PowerEdge servers and an expanded NVIDIA-collaboration agentic AI system. A constructive read would extend the data-center capital cycle thesis carrying VST, NEE, LRCX, TSM, and CRDO; an in-line or hotter PCE print would keep the rate-cut path slipping further out and constrain multiple expansion across the IOWN rate-sensitive holdings. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The digital-asset complex sat quiet into the weekend with Bitcoin spot trading range-bound near \$76,600 per the live tape — the late-week ETF weakness (IBIT ↓2.36%, ETHA ↓3.59% Friday) has not extended through Saturday and Sunday, isolating the move as positioning-led rather than a broader risk-off signal. Per Yahoo Finance coverage of the Friday close, both bitcoin and ether moved little on the week as the broader equity tape held its weekly streak. For the IOWN digital-asset sleeve, the weekend stability against a still-cautious Fear & Greed reading of 25 keeps the small, beta-distinct allocation framing intact — the holdings continue to behave on their own positioning rather than as a clean risk-on or risk-off proxy. A confirmed Iran framework Tuesday morning could broaden the risk-on read into digital assets if it materially compresses the geopolitical premium across the tape. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

4. Week Ahead — Memorial Day closes Monday, Tuesday brings Consumer Confidence and Case-Shiller into a session absorbing three calendar days of news, and Thursday concentrates the week's catalysts (PCE, GDP, Dell) into a single morning before the Chicago PMI rounds out Friday. Markets close Monday for Memorial Day per the NYSE schedule; Tuesday brings the S&P CoreLogic Case-Shiller Home Price Index and the Conference Board's Consumer Confidence reading; Wednesday delivers New Residential Sales; Thursday stacks the second GDP estimate and the April PCE Deflator at 8:30 AM ET; Friday rounds out with the Chicago Business Barometer. On the corporate side — per multiple earnings calendars referenced in our coverage — Dell Technologies reports Thursday before the open as the AI-server bellwether. None of the named reporters are IOWN holdings, but the read-throughs to the data-center capital cycle the semiconductor and power sleeves depend on are direct. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

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